## READINESS AND WEARINESS Matthew 25:1–1

Readiness is compatible with weariness. In the parable of the ten bridesmaids, all ten fall asleep, including the wise. Jesus does not condemn their tiredness. The difference lies in the oil they have brought.
We might understand that oil as our willingness to open our hearts to Christ: to receive his love, acknowledge our need, and allow him to sustain us. We cannot manufacture grace, but we can make room to receive it.
Sometimes we imagine that being ready for God means having everything accomplished, our problems resolved, and our weaknesses overcome. Yet Christ can meet us amid unfinished tasks, anxious thoughts, and tired bodies. Our weariness need not close our hearts.
Even a simple prayer can keep the lamp of faith burning: "Lord, I am tired, but I am here. Help me welcome you."
The Bridegroom comes to gather us into his joy. Readiness means remaining willing to receive the love he offers, even when we have little strength.

**NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF PERPETUAL HELP** will continue on Tuesday at the 7.15pm Mass. Please place Petitions in the box at the front of the altar.

**ANNIVERSARIES** We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Paul McElhinney, Elizabeth Breslin, Maire Coyle, Margaret Hasson, Benny McLaughlin

**SUNDAY COLLECTION** 1st Nov £2506.36 & €161.91 Standing Orders £400 **2nd Collection** £932.51 & €54.60 Thank you for your generosity

**HOLY FAMILY PARISH DRAW**
Our Parish Draw will begin in January 2027 to provide funds for the refurbishment and future capital needs of our Parish. Monthly subscription of **£10 by standing order or cash payment of £120 for year**. Part payments for a ticket can be made to the parish office over the next twelve weeks Tickets on sale and standing order forms available after Masses every weekend or at the parish office from this weekend. All standing order and cash payments need to be completed by 10th January for the first draw on **Saturday 30th Jan.** A subscriber to the Draw must be at least 18 years of age.

**PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD**
During this month of November let us pray for the deceased priests who served our diocese and our parishes as we pray for the men who will take up their mantle in the years to come. There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, today Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, pgoh2111@gmail.com (028) 79386259

**DERRY DIOCESAN PILGRIMAGE TO LOURDES 2027**, led by Bishop Michael Router: There are two options available as follows:
**Option 1**: 8 - 13 July, 5 nights, £980, from City of Derry Airport, with priority given to Assisted Pilgrims and family members, Care Team, Youth, Youth Leaders and Priests
**Option 2**: 7 - 14 July, 7 nights, £1,095, from Belfast International Airport.
Single Supplement and Travel Insurance will be extra. Expressions of Interest can be emailed to derrypilgrim@outlook.com. Bookings will begin in mid-January, with more details later. Pilgrimage Gift Vouchers of any value are available from the Pastoral Centre, Bishop Street, Derry, for anyone wishing to purchase them, particularly as a Christmas Gift. Please contact 028 7136 2475 for further info.

**ANAM CARA'S** next Bereavement Information Evening will centre around where creativity intersects with grief with renowned author and psychotherapist, Sasha Bates. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died, regardless of the age of their child, circumstances of their death, or time since bereavement. This event will take place online on Thursday 19 November at 7pm. For more info info@anamcara.ie or call 085 288 8888

**FREE 4- Week Dementia Education Programme for Family Carers**
Starting Thursday 21 January 2027, 7.00pm at the Health for Life Healthy Living Centre, Creggan. Designed for those supporting a loved one with a dementia diagnosis at home. Learn about dementia, communication, behaviours, coping strategies, and available supports. Family members are welcome to attend together. Please note: this course is not suitable for people living with dementia or those currently undergoing assessment/diagnosis. **Booking essential:** eilish.brown@healthforlifenw.org | 028 7137 3870.

**Choir-ee-okee**
*Singing for joy and wellbeing*
**Tuesday 10th November starting at 7.00pm**
**Seamus Heaney HomePlace, Bellaghy**
In aid of Parkinson's UK.



**Stage Reading by Off the Cuff Theatre**
**'The Long Now'**
Seamus Heaney HomePlace, Bellaghy
**Friday 13th November at 7.30 pm**
Admission: **£10.**



**K-Pop Inspired Class with Selena**
**Tuesday 10th November** (5 week course)
4.00 pm - 5.30 pm
Mayogall Hall
**Contact Selena on 07561533135.**



**Safeguarding Notice:** Should you have any concerns regarding the safeguarding of children or vulnerable people within the church, please contact **Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or e-mail dlp@derrydiocese.org. PSNI Tel 101. Northern HSCT Gateway Services on 028 9442 4459. Emergency Social Work Services on: 0800 1979 995.**




**PARISH OFFICE**
Please have all Anniversaries names & News Items in **by WEDNESDAY** each week.

The Parish Office is open
**Monday - Thursday from 10.00 am.**

**Thank-You**






# Lavey Parish

Tel: (028) 7964 2458
E-Mail: laveyparish@derrydiocese.org
Web: www.laveyparish.com

*Jesus said to the crowds:* ***"Stay awake, because you do not know either the day or the hour."*** *These words of Jesus are usually heard as a warning about being prepared for death and, no doubt, they are that. But they are also a call to be prepared for life! It is so easy to get used to even the most wonderful gifts of life and love and take them for granted. Our call is to be alert to these and to celebrate them daily, especially in our love relationships of marriage and family life and also within the community of faith. We miss out on so much joy and happiness with each other. Husbands and wives get so busy that they have no time to be with each other and to enjoy their marriage. Parents are so focused on giving their children as much as possible that they can neglect the most important thing of all, the gift of themselves. And in the faith community we can be so intent on doing our duty that we neglect to enjoy what we are doing.*



***Father Johnny Doherty, C.Ss.R.***

## MASS SCHEDULE

| | |
|---|---|
| Monday 9th November | **9.15 am Mass** |
| Tuesday 10th November | **7.00 pm Mass** |
| *Month's Mind Mass for Brendan Ward* | |
| Wednesday 11th November | **9.15 am Mass** |
| | **7.00 pm Mass** |
| *Parish Mass for Our Dead* | |
| Thursday 12th November | **9.15 am Mass** |
| Friday 13th November | **9.15 am Mass** |

***Adoration** will begin **after morning Mass** and conclude at **5.00 pm.***

## 33RD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

| | |
|---|---|
| Saturday 14th November | **5:15 pm - 5:45 pm - Confessions** |
| | **6:00 pm Mass** |
| *Month's Mind Mass for Maureen Doole* | |
| Sunday 15th November | **9:00 am Mass** |
| | **11:00 am Mass** |

## MASS OF REMEMBRANCE

We will hold our Annual Mass of Remembrance for everyone who has died or been buried in our parish over the past year this

Wednesday 11th November at 7.00pm.



**Parish Collections: 1st November**

Weekly: **£1,119.50**
Building: **£1,197.00**
Loose Coin: **£547.78**

**Thank you for your continued support!**




*Sunday 8th November - 32nd Sunday in Ordinary Time*

**Sacred Heart Messenger**

The subscription for the 2027 Sacred Heart Messenger is now due of **£26**. Please return payment to the Parish Office or Sacristy.




**Extra Vigil Mass - Saturday 21st November**

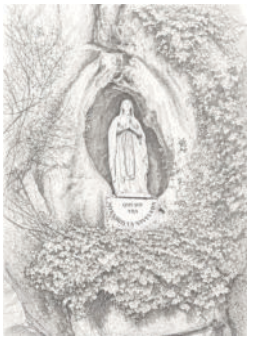
To accommodate those attending the Club Gala on **Saturday, 21st November,** we will hold an additional Mass at **3.00 pm** that afternoon.




**SACRAMENTAL TALK:** The Derry Catechetical Team will hold a Sacramental Talk in **St. Brigid's Primary School** on **Wednesday18th November, starting at 7:00 pm**. The team will work with pupils in Primary 4 and Primary 7 in their classrooms and will deliver a presentation to parents and guardians in the Assembly Hall. We welcome all families whose children are preparing to receive the sacraments next year.




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**Bookings will begin in mid-January, with more details later.**

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**Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick**
**Thirty Second Sunday in Ordinary Time - Year A – 8th November 2026**
**Parish Clergy:** Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215
Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)
**Email**: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.leckpatrickparish.com
**Email**: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com
**Email:** clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.clonleighparish.com

**Gospel Reflection *(Matthew 25:1-13)***

In today's gospel, Jesus tells the parable of ten virgins who were waiting for the bridegroom. Five were wise because they brought extra oil for their lamps, while the other five were foolish because they failed to prepare. When the bridegroom finally arrived, those who were ready entered the wedding celebration, while the others were left behind. Through this parable, Jesus reminds us of the importance of being spiritually prepared because we do not know when He will return.

The lamp is a symbol of our lives, our faith, and our relationship with God. Just as a lamp needs oil to continue burning, our spiritual lives need to be constantly nourished through prayer, love, acts of kindness, and unwavering trust in the Lord. We are called to remain vigilant and faithful, keeping our hearts close to God so that our faith never grows weak or runs dry. By living according to His will each day, we stay prepared for the return of Jesus. Rather than fearing His coming, we should look forward to it with joyful anticipation, confidence, and hope, knowing that a life rooted in faith and obedience allows us to welcome Him with hearts full of peace and devotion.

***Loving God, thank You for always being with me. Help me keep the lamp of my faith burning brightly each day. May I always be ready to welcome You with joy, hope, and a faithful heart.***

**Remembering Our Deceased Loved Ones** During the month of November, we are especially encouraged to remember and pray for the faithful departed, those members of our families and dearly beloved who have gone before us marked with the sign of faith. As we pray for all our holy souls, we think also of all who grieve at this time.

**Prayer For All The Deceased**

*God our Father, Your power brings us to birth, Your providence guides our lives, and by Your command we return to dust. Lord, those who die still live in Your presence, their lives change but do not end. I pray in hope for my family, relatives and friends, and for all the dead known to You alone. In company with Christ, who died and now lives, may they rejoice in Your kingdom, where all our tears are wiped away. Unite us together again in one family to sing Your praise forever and ever.*

***May the Divine Assistance remain always with us, and may the souls of the faithful departed, through the mercy of God, rest in peace. Amen.***

**Requiescant in Pace** We offer our sympathy of the family and friends of
John McConnell, Derry Rd, Strabane
Joe Cullen, Lower Main St, Strabane
Ann Wallace, Alexander Place, Strabane